RICARDO CUNHA

Principal Engineer

+5561981221885 ricardo.cunha@gmail.com Brazilian, Remote (UTC to UTC-7)



EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

ZappyRide by J.D. Power

03/2021 USA (Remote)

- Reporting direct to the CTO, technical leadership for the frontend and backend teams, managed a team of 6 developers, fostering strong communication skills and collaboration to ensure project success and alignment with organizational goals
- Designed AI agent applications using RAG, LLM chains to extract data and populate the data layer, built data flows using N8N to integrate external public data reducing the manual data collection in 90%
- Designed AWS cloud solutions and new products, and handled Infrastructure as Code using Terraform ensuring 100% fit between the environments configuration
- Developed Disaster Recovery solutions for multi-region AWS EKS deployments to ensure high availability and minimize downtime hitting the company's SLA for the last 4 years
- Collaborated with backend and frontend engineers to design REST APIs, reducing API load time by 60% through implementing an additional caching strategies and performance improvements
- Drive product innovation by using Agile methodologies, enforcing programming best practices, and encouraging the team to think creatively and stay up to date with the latest industry trends
- Demonstrated expertise in database design for MySQL, PostgreSQL, and NoSQL, and coding practices ensuring high-quality, efficient, and maintainable software solutions

Lead Software Engineer

Crossover

01/2018 - 02/2021 USA (Remote)

- Evaluated companies for acquisition, stabilized, automated, and centralized all products from the acquired companies to ensure smooth integration reducing 70% of the failures in the process
- Reverse-engineered multiple products, creating detailed design diagrams, planning infrastructure migration, and defining optimal team size to successfully integrate each product into the factory model
- Successfully integrated external products from companies such as Sococo, ScaleArc, Symphony Commerce, Layer, Infinio, and Street Smart AI with a 100% success rate into the engineering ecosystem
- Managed the migration of products to fit the new organizational structure and replaced the current infrastructure with cost-effective solutions to reduce expenses achieving better ROI for all the cases
- Hands on coding for the authentication platforms across the company
- Designed and implemented payment gateway system to be used as bridge for Stripe, PayPal running over Kafka integrated to Symphony Commerce
- Enhanced Sococo's real-time analytics performance by optimizing MongoDB schemas, indexes, and query operations

SUMMARY

Results-driven Principal Engineer with over **20 years** of experience building fast, scalable solutions for U.S. companies. Throughout my career, I have tackled projects across diverse industries such as insurance, payments, logistics, e-commerce, telecommunications, automotive. Passionate about solving tough problems and improving software architecture to create excellent user experiences. Looking to use my technical skills and leadership to help dynamic, fast-moving, and innovative companies succeed. Web3 / Blockchain enthusiast ready to move to a company that works in this field.

Skills and Expertise

- Fast, reusable code development
- Strong debugging and code-quality improvements
- Automation of deployment, scaling, and performance tuning
- Simple, reliable CI/CD setups
- Scalable, secure cloud infrastructure using IaC best practices

Other Strengths

- Experienced in remote, agile teams
- Independent, proactive problem solver
- Committed to clean, testable, efficient code
- Fast learner, passionate about new ideas and AI agents
- Comfortable in startup environments and full end-to-end work (frontend, backend, infra)
- Fluent English speaker and communicator

EDUCATION

Computer Science

Centro Universitário de Brasília - UniCEUB

07/2004 - 07/2008 Brasilia

- Bachelor degree, Centro Universitario de Brasília - UniCEUB, Brasília

SKILLS

Backend

Golang Java GRPC Python

Node.js Django GraphQL

NestJS

EXPERIENCE

IT Solutions Consultant

IBM

03/2017 - 01/2018 Brazil (Remote)

- Hired to develop frontend architectures to enable efficient, testable, scalable, and modular development for the E-Learning internal platform
- Developed frontend architecture for React.js (ES6) and Angular using Webpack and Jest, enabling efficient and testable UI development, mentoring juniors developers in 2 different international teams (Netherlands and USA)

Solutions Architect

Altran

03/2016 - 03/2017 Brasilia, DF, Brazil

- Hired as Solutions Architect, responsible for improving, implementing, and integrating company-wide insurance solutions
- Successfully migrated legacy JSF projects to modern React/Go applications, improving the response time in 30%, reduced the server resources in 40%

Software Architect

CTIS Informatica S/A

09/2013 - 03/2016 Brasilia, DF, Brazil

- Increased grant approval efficiency by 30% through strategic process optimization initiatives.
- Led enterprise app development, managing design, performance, scalability, and integration for quality solutions.

Developer

CTIS Informatica S/A

09/2005 - 09/2013 Brasilia, DF, Brazil

- Working at Correios, the Brazilian Post-office company (www.correios.com.br)
- Developed and maintained SARA, an automation system for Brazilian Post, using Java Swing for the desktop application and integrating various peripherals such as printers, pin pads, and scales
- Refactored the peripheral integration reducing the time the integration in 60%
- Improvement the performance in 70% implementing caching strategies and reducing payload size

SKILLS

Frontend

Angular · React

Databases / Streaming / Messages

MySQL · PostgreSQL · DynamoDB · Cassandra · Redis · Elasticsearch · OpenSearch · MongoDB · Kafka · SQL

AI

MCP · RAG · LLM Finetuning

Cloud / DevOps / IAC

Kubernetes (EKS GKE) · AWS · GCP · Terraform · GitHub Actions · GitLab · Prometheus · Grafana

Web3

Solidity · geth · Solana · EVM

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

Google Professional Cloud Architect

LANGUAGES

English
Proficient

FIND ME ONLINE

GitHub
ricardocunha

LinkedIn
ricardopereiradacunha

Stack Overflow
https://stackoverflow.com/users/635573/ricardo-cunha